

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 Security | Cloud Security | Identity and Access Management | Microsoft Defender | Microsoft Sentinel

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a senior cyber security engineer with over five years of experience designing, implementing, reviewing, and managing security measures to protect Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 environments. I have an extensive track record managing enterprise security controls across cloud and hybrid infrastructure, with deep expertise in Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Microsoft Sentinel, and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM). I bring strong operational and engineering experience alongside a thorough grounding in security best practices across cloud workloads, identity management, endpoint protection, and Security Information and Event Management (SIEM). I also hold extensive experience with CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification. I am committed to building resilient, well-governed security controls that protect organisations as they grow and evolve their cloud infrastructure.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Azure Security:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Azure security posture management
- **Microsoft 365 Security:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender (XDR), Microsoft Purview, Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM
- **Security Information and Event Management (SIEM):** Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, detection rule engineering, log source onboarding, alert tuning
- **Endpoint Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), MDE deployment and configuration, attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, automated investigation and response (AIR)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM platform administration, privileged account lifecycle management, least-privilege enforcement
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentra Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Security Automation:** PowerShell scripting, Microsoft Sentinel automation rules, Logic Apps, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) workflow development
- **Network and Email Security:** Mimecast email security gateway, Check Point Harmony firewall, Intrusion Detection and Prevention Systems (IDS/IPS), web application firewall (WAF)
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK framework-aligned detection and response
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+
- **Certifications:** Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP), CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL)
Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

March 2025 - Present

- Design, implement, and manage security measures protecting the organisation's Microsoft Azure and Microsoft 365 environments, applying Azure and M365 security best practices across identity, endpoint, collaboration, and cloud workloads.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) security controls including Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), MFA enforcement, and Single Sign-On (SSO) integrations to reduce identity-based attack surface.

- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across the enterprise estate, configuring attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, automated investigation and response (AIR) actions, and custom detections aligned to the organisation's threat model.
- Operate Microsoft Sentinel as the primary SIEM platform, developing Kusto Query Language (KQL)-based detection rules, onboarding new log sources, and maintaining high-quality alerts across Azure, M365, and endpoint telemetry.
- Administer Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), enforcing device compliance policies and managing application security across corporate and bring-your-own-device endpoints.
- Manage BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), governing privileged account lifecycles, enforcing least-privilege principles, and producing audit-ready access and session reports.
- Automate security operations and administrative tasks using PowerShell scripting and Microsoft Sentinel automation rules, improving operational efficiency and reducing manual workload across recurring security tasks.
- Lead vulnerability management activities using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) and Tenable.io, risk-prioritising findings and tracking remediation with infrastructure and application teams.

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across an 8,000-user estate, working with infrastructure teams to roll out the agent, configure policies, and validate detection and response capability at scale.
- Designed and maintained Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) Conditional Access policies and MFA configurations to protect cloud-hosted applications, services, and privileged accounts.
- Operated Microsoft Sentinel daily, writing KQL queries to investigate security events and build correlation rules covering Azure, M365, endpoint, and network log sources.
- Investigated Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) detections relating to Active Directory-based attacks, coordinating containment and remediation with directory services and infrastructure teams.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM deployment, enforcing device compliance baselines, configuring application protection policies, and managing conditional access integration for device compliance requirements.
- Monitored CrowdStrike Falcon EDR alerts, triaging and investigating endpoint threats and coordinating incident response activities through the full containment and eradication lifecycle.
- Administered BeyondTrust PAM to manage privileged access across on-premises and cloud environments, providing a fully auditable privileged session management capability.
- Managed Mimecast email security gateway and Check Point Harmony firewall policies, collaborating with network teams to maintain robust perimeter security controls.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, producing risk-based reports and working with system owners to validate and track remediation.
- Contributed to Cyber Essentials+, ISO 27001, and CIS Controls security programme activities, supporting control evidence gathering and audit preparation.

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and managed security controls across Microsoft 365 and cloud infrastructure, configuring identity management, endpoint security, and access control policies aligned to security best practices.
- Managed Microsoft 365 security settings including Conditional Access, MFA, and role-based access controls to protect the organisation's SaaS applications and data.
- Supported cloud infrastructure security governance, reviewing configurations against industry frameworks and producing risk-based recommendations for improvement.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning and patch management, maintaining up-to-date visibility of the organisation's vulnerability posture and tracking remediation of critical findings.
- Supported IT infrastructure operations including network configuration, server administration, and security-related service desk escalations.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) to 8,000 users at UAL, establishing comprehensive endpoint detection and automated response capability across a complex hybrid Azure and on-premises estate.
- Designed and enforced a comprehensive set of Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies and MFA controls, significantly reducing identity-related risk across cloud and hybrid workloads.
- Built and refined a portfolio of KQL-based detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel covering Azure, M365, endpoint, and network telemetry, improving threat visibility and reducing false-positive alert rates.
- Implemented Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM across the estate, establishing device compliance baselines, application protection policies, and conditional access integration for managed and unmanaged devices.
- Operationalised BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), eliminating uncontrolled privileged access and providing full privileged session recording and audit capability.
- Designed PowerShell-based SOAR automation workflows within Microsoft Sentinel to streamline high-frequency alert handling, reducing analyst manual workload and accelerating incident response timescales.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Remote (UK)